



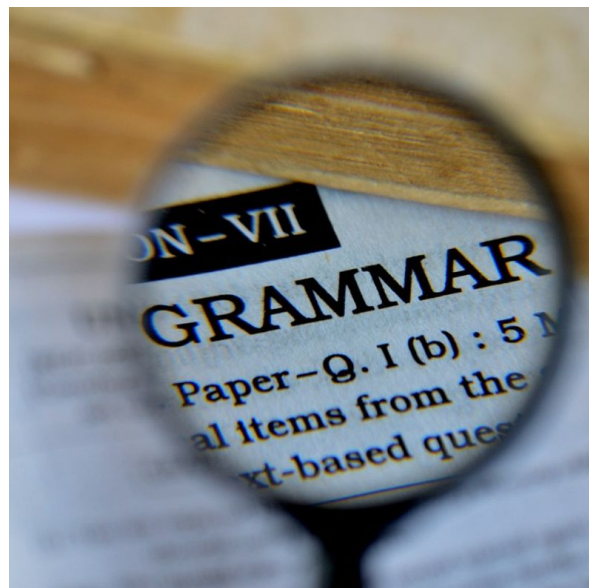
DIRECT AND INDIRECT QUESTIONS



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Expemo code:

1DP5-93N8-1R5L



1

Presentation

When we ask for information, we often use **direct questions**: *Where is it?*

If we want to be more polite or formal, we can use **indirect questions**: *Can you tell me where it is?*

Direct questions	Indirect questions
Direct questions are normal questions: What time is it? How long does the journey take? Why are you crying? How long have you been living here? Is he at home? Did she reply to your email?	Indirect questions begin with Could you tell me ..., Can you tell me ..., I'd like to know ..., Do you know ..., etc.: Can you tell me what time it is? Do you know how long the journey takes? I'd like to know why you are crying. Could you tell me how long you've been living here? Do you know if he is at home? I wonder if she replied to your email.



Rules for forming direct and indirect questions

Direct questions can be **simple questions** (*Are you at home?*), **subject questions** (*Who won the match?*) or **object questions** (*What did they win?*).

With **simple questions** and **object questions** we use special word order for questions:

If there is a 'helping verb' (*auxiliary verb*), for example **will**, **was**, **have** and **can**, we put the subject after the *auxiliary verb*:

Can you help me? Where **will Allie** be tonight? How many languages **can you** speak?

In **present simple** and **past simple** questions, we use **do/does/did**:

Where **do they** live? **Did you** call me?

Indirect questions have the same word order as statements (*subject before verb*):

Do you know how long **the journey takes**?

We do not use **do/does/did** in the question: Do you know how long ~~does the journey take~~?

If there is no question word (**who**, **where**, **why**, **how**, etc.) in the **direct question**, we can use **if** or **whether** in the **indirect question**:

I wonder **if** she replied to your email.

I wonder **whether** she replied to your email.

2

Practice 1

Rewrite the questions below as indirect questions.

- Where is the nearest hotel?
Could you tell me where the nearest hotel is?
- How do you say this in English?
I'd like to know
- Do you have this shirt in a smaller size?
Can you tell me?
- How long did the meeting take?
I wonder
- How did you fix the television?
Can you explain?
- Where are you going to stay this weekend?
Please tell me
- How long has he been waiting?
I don't know
- Why did you come to our country?
I'm curious



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Practice 2

Complete the job interview below.



Interviewer: Let's talk about your previous job. Could you describe _____¹ (what were your responsibilities?)

Michelle: Well, my duties included answering the phone, dealing with customers and organising meetings for the director.

Interviewer: And can you tell us _____² (why did you quit?)

Michelle: Well, after 5 years in the same company, I felt that I was ready for a different challenge.

Interviewer: Could you tell us _____³
(why would you like to work for our company?)

Michelle: Yes. Your company is well-known all over the world.

Interviewer: Hmm. I'd like to know _____⁴. (what are your weaknesses?)

Michelle: Well, I am a perfectionist, and sometimes this can be a problem. But I'm working on it.

Interviewer: OK. Please let us know _____⁵ (can you start next week?)

Now listen to check your answers.

Audio

